

Technology Cheat Sheet for Video-Conferencing Platforms

This guide is not an exhaustive list of all available Zoom or Doxy.me functions. Platform features, layouts, and settings continue to evolve, and the information here reflects updates as of 2025. Depending on the version or device you are using, some controls may appear differently or offer additional options. Clinicians are encouraged to explore their platform settings regularly and stay familiar with current features to support smooth, safe, and effective group meetings.

ZOOM: How to Use Core Functions

1. Waiting Room

Allows participants to enter individually so you can verify their identity and protect confidentiality.

How to use:

1. Open Zoom and go to Settings (gear icon).
2. Go to Security and turn on Waiting Room.
3. During the meeting, click Participants and then click Admit next to each participant.

2. Mute / Unmute Participants

Use this to reduce background noise during psychoeducation or grounding exercises. Participants may mute themselves, but the facilitator can mute everyone if needed.

How to use:

1. Click Participants at the bottom of the Zoom window.
2. Select Mute All as appropriate.

3. Using the Chat Box

Open Chat:

1. Click Chat on the bottom toolbar.
2. A chat panel will open on the right side of the screen.

Sending Messages:

- Type your message in the box and press Enter.
- Messages go to Everyone by default.
- To send privately (if clinically appropriate), click the dropdown above the chat box and select a participant's name.

Changing Chat Permissions:

1. Click the three dots (More) in the chat window.
2. Set permissions to Everyone, Host and co-hosts only, or No one.
3. For safety, you may wish to disable participant-to-participant private messages.

Disabling Chat Saving:

1. Go to Settings → Recording (web portal).
2. Disable Save Chat and Auto-transcription.

4. Screen Sharing

How to use:

1. Click Share Screen.
2. Select the window or desktop to share.
3. Check “Share sound” if you are playing audio or video.
4. Click Share.
5. Stop sharing by clicking the red Stop Share button.

5. Noise Suppression (Important for music or videos)

Zoom may automatically filter out music or background audio, causing it to fade in and out.

How to adjust:

1. Open Zoom → Settings → Audio.
2. Click Advanced (bottom right).
3. Set Noise Suppression to Low.
4. Turn on “Show option to enable Original sound for musicians.”
5. In your meeting, click “Turn on Original Sound” at the top left.

Result: Videos and music will play smoothly without being filtered out.

6. Breakout Rooms

Breakout rooms can be used for individual check-ins or small-group exercises. It is recommended to schedule the check-ins to minimize participant waiting time.

How to use:

1. Click Breakout Rooms.
2. Choose the number of rooms and assign participants automatically or manually.
3. Click Create and then Open All Rooms.
4. Move between rooms using Join.
5. Send messages to everyone using Broadcast (e.g., “Thank you for your patience”).
6. Click Close All Rooms to return participants to the main meeting.

7. Security Controls

Lock Meeting:

1. Click Security on the toolbar.
2. Select Lock Meeting.

Remove Participant:

- Click Participants, hover over the participant, then select Remove.

DOXY.ME: How to Use Core Functions

(Group meetings available in Professional/Clinic plans.)

1. Waiting Room

How to use:

1. Clients join using your room link.
2. You will see them appear in your waiting room queue.
3. Click their name and select Start to bring them into the meeting.

2. Mute / Unmute Participants

How to use:

1. Hover over a participant's video tile.
2. Click the Microphone icon to mute or unmute.

3. Opening the Chat

How to open chat:

1. Click the Chat icon (speech bubble) on the left or bottom toolbar.
2. A chat panel will appear on the side of the screen.

Sending Messages:

- Type in the message field and press Enter.
- All messages go to everyone in the group meeting (no private chats).
- Chat messages disappear after the call, supporting confidentiality.

4. Screen Sharing

How to use:

1. Click Share Screen on the bottom toolbar.
2. Select Entire Screen, Window, or Browser Tab.
3. Click Share.
4. Click Stop Sharing when finished.

5. Managing Group Layout

How to switch views:

1. Click Layout (usually at the top right).
2. Select Grid View for equal visibility.
3. Select Speaker View to highlight the person speaking or presenting.

Note: This guide is a supportive overview and **is not an exhaustive list of all platform features**. Features and layouts may change over time. This information reflects updates as of 2025. Depending on your device or version, some options may appear differently or include additional features. Clinicians are encouraged to explore platform settings regularly to maintain smooth, safe, and effective group meetings.